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AFTER SIVARASAN RETURNED FROM THE BLAST SITE, WHICH WAS PAST midnight, the first thing he did was make a call to Subha Sundaram, asking him to retrieve Haribabu's camera at any cost. Accomplishing the task would be child's play in normal times. Since that was not the case, Sundaram dialled a VIP number straight away the next morning—that of the state Congress president Vazhappady Ramamurthy—and sought his help. Ramamurthy had reached Delhi by that time, accompanying his leader's coffin. Sundaram had called around 10 in the morning. 'My boy, one Haribabu, had been to Sriperumbudur to take photographs and has not returned. Don't know what happened to my camera.' He asked the Congress leader if he could make an inquiry into the same.[1] 'Where is your boy Haribabu?'

'He is dead. The camera must have been seized by the police.' Sundaram requested Ramamurthy to use his influence and get him the camera. Being in Delhi and amid a disaster, Ramamurthy was not able to look into such a request. 'The matter is under investigation. The camera you are looking for must have been collected by the police. I should not be asking them to part with it.'

Next morning, news published in *The Hindu* implicated Haribabu in the assassination and referred to his ties with the LTTE. Sundaram swung into action and summoned Haribabu's father Sundarmani to his studio. He asked the father to immediately issue a denial and counter the story linking his son with the Tamil Tigers. Sundaram had the statement ready and typed. He took Sundarmani's signature on it and made over a hundred photocopies. Sundarmani took the copies and distributed them in media houses.

The second attack on Anirudhya was from the DMK supremo M. Karunanidhi. He called the journalist an agent of the CBI in his weekly